

GIRIDHARAN RAJENDRAN

Principal Engineer | Engineering Manager | Platform Engineering | DevSecOps | AI Agentic Systems

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Hands-on Senior Engineer and Technical Leader with 20 years of experience architecting cloud-native systems, AI-agentic platforms, and DevSecOps pipelines at enterprise scale — while building, scaling, and retaining world-class engineering teams. Operates at Principal Engineer and Staff Engineer level: making independent architectural decisions, setting technical standards, writing production code, and driving cross-organizational technical strategy. Pioneered T-Mobile's first AI-agentic developer platform on Anthropic's Model Context Protocol (MCP) — independently designed the full system architecture including MCP tool-orchestration layer, RAG pipeline (ChromaDB), REST API specifications, streaming response handling, and zero trust security boundaries. Simultaneously proven Engineering Leader: managed 12-member SRE team, drove \$1.2M+ in annual cost optimization, and delivered 5x deployment frequency improvement across 40+ agile teams.

CORE COMPETENCIES

System Architecture and Design AI Agentic Systems Model Context Protocol (MCP) Generative AI (GenAI) Large Language Models (LLM) Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) Cloud-Native Architecture Platform Engineering Developer Experience (DevEx) Site Reliability Engineering (SRE) DevSecOps Infrastructure as Code (IaC) Distributed Systems Microservices Event-driven Architecture REST API Design Zero Trust Security High Availability and Scalability Kubernetes Terraform CI/CD Pipelines GitOps Observability FinOps and Cost Optimization Engineering Leadership People Management Talent Development Headcount Planning Performance Management Stakeholder Management Technical Program Management Strategic Planning OKR-driven Execution Agile SAFe Cross-functional Collaboration

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI and Agentic Systems: Anthropic Model Context Protocol (MCP), Claude API, Azure OpenAI (GPT-4o), LLM, RAG, ChromaDB, vector databases, AI agentic systems, prompt engineering, event-driven AI workflows, developer experience (DevEx), Cursor AI, GitHub Copilot

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, EKS, S3, IAM, Lambda, CloudWatch), Azure (AKS, ADO, Key Vault, Data Explorer), GCP; multi-cloud, cloud-native and hybrid architectures; high availability and disaster recovery

DevSecOps and CI/CD: GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, CircleCI, ArgoCD, GitOps, SonarQube, SAST/DAST, policy-as-code, zero trust security, SOX compliance automation, shift-left security, security posture management

Containers and Orchestration: Kubernetes (EKS, AKS), Docker, Helm, Istio service mesh, auto-scaling, microservices architecture, REST API design, serverless

IaC and Engineering: Terraform, Pulumi, Ansible, Python, Golang, FastAPI, Next.js, Bash scripting, Backstage.io (Internal Developer Platform), workflow orchestration

Observability and SRE: Grafana, Prometheus, Datadog, Splunk, distributed tracing, SLI/SLO/SLA frameworks, chaos engineering, blameless postmortems, MTTR reduction, production incident management

Data and Streaming: Apache Kafka, Azure Data Explorer, data pipeline automation, real-time telemetry, event-driven architecture

Leadership: People management, talent development, headcount planning, hiring, performance management, career development, succession planning, stakeholder management, architecture review boards, vendor management, budget governance, technical roadmaps, Agile/SAFe/Scrum

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Engineer, Lead -- SRE, DevSecOps and Platform Engineering | **T-Mobile USA** | Oct 2019 -

Present

- **CDP Hub -- AI-Powered Platform Copilot (Flagship Innovation Project):** Independently architected T-Mobile's first AI-agentic developer platform on Anthropic's Model Context Protocol (MCP). Designed the complete system architecture: MCP tool-orchestration layer exposing 15+ REST API capabilities, RAG pipeline with ChromaDB vector store, streaming response handling, and zero trust security boundaries. AI assistants (Claude, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, GPT-4o) invoke tools autonomously -- CI/CD telemetry, RAG-powered documentation search, automated GitLab workflows (project creation, pipeline monitoring, failure diagnosis). Reduced idea-to-deployment time from days to minutes. Delivered production Next.js chat UI adopted across engineering teams. Stack: Python, FastAPI, Anthropic MCP, Claude API, Azure OpenAI, ChromaDB, GitLab API, Next.js, Kubernetes.
- Established technical standards, architecture review boards, and engineering excellence frameworks adopted across 40+ agile teams; defined multi-year cloud-native platform roadmap aligned with enterprise IT strategy; drove FinOps cost optimization and cloud governance frameworks across engineering domains.
- Architected migration of 100+ enterprise workloads to Azure and Kubernetes using Terraform, ArgoCD, and GitOps; reduced infrastructure costs by 85% and generated \$1.2M+ in annual savings through capacity planning and cloud-native rearchitecture.
- Designed and built cloud-native GitLab CI/CD pipelines with SAST/DAST scanning, zero trust security controls, SonarQube quality gates, and policy-as-code governance; improved deployment frequency 5x and build reliability 60%; automated 90% of SOX controls saving 800+ engineering hours annually.
- Architected distributed observability platform (Grafana, Prometheus, Datadog) with automated RCA workflows, SLI/SLO/SLA tracking, and chaos engineering practices; reduced MTTR by 45% and system outages by 30% YoY; maintained 99.9% high availability across mission-critical systems.
- Led and scaled a 12-member SRE engineering team; drove people management, headcount planning, hiring, performance management, and career development programs — improved team satisfaction 25% YoY and nurtured engineers into leadership-ready roles; delivered executive KPI dashboards reducing stakeholder reporting time by 75%.

Associate Manager, Software Engineering | **Accenture** | Sep 2010 - Oct 2019

- Directed T-Mobile's Rebellion platform modernization and DevSecOps transformation; independently designed automation frameworks that cut release cycles by 70%; defined technical standards and engineering practices adopted organization-wide through automation-first SRE architecture.
- People management lead for 14-person cross-functional engineering team spanning DevOps, operations, and environment engineering; drove hiring, performance management, career development, and employee engagement — increased team productivity 65% through Agile coaching and CI/CD adoption.

- Automated 90% of manual operations tasks using Python and shell scripting; provided 24x7 on-call and SWAT support for 52+ applications; maintained 99.9% SLA and disaster recovery readiness across production and non-production environments.
- Collaborated with executive leadership to define multi-year technology roadmaps aligned with enterprise OKRs; implemented monitoring and alerting systems boosting incident response by 60%.

Senior Software Engineer | **Alcatel-Lucent** | Oct 2009 - Sep 2010

- Developed Unix/Python automation tooling and REST API integrations; independently designed deployment pipeline architecture reducing manual overhead by 30%; led OS patching and production release coordination across distributed systems.

System Engineer | **Wipro Technologies** | Jan 2008 - Sep 2009

- Designed and built standardized release management frameworks and automated build systems; developed platform intake processes reducing environment setup timelines by 40%.

Junior Engineer | **LASON India Pvt Ltd** | May 2006 - Sep 2007

- Built DevOps platform automation and CI/CD pipeline implementations for enterprise document processing applications.

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration (MBA), In Progress -- University of Phoenix (Expected 2026) | Relevant coursework: Data Analysis and Business Analytics, The Digital Economy

Post Graduate Program in Cloud Computing -- University of Texas at Austin (2021)

Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.) in Electronics and Communication Engineering -- Anna University, India (2005)

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

AI and ML

- Generative AI and Machine Learning (ML) Fundamentals
- Agentic AI
- AI Risk Management

DevOps and SRE

- GitLab Certified Git Associate
- Red Hat Certified Engineer (RHCE)
- SRE Management

Architecture

- Certified Technology Architect
- SAE 5 Product Owner and Product Manager

Leadership

- Leadership Development Program -- Bothell University, Washington State